



#### IN BRIEF

## WORLD WAR I

Women's contributions to the war effort were varied. Amid the large-scale movements, some singular heroines emerged and many died for their country.

### 1914

Pamphlets encourage women to contribute on the home front. German women are later asked to donate their hair due to textile shortages.

### 1915

**June** English reporter Dorothy Lawrence travels to France and visits the front line disguised as a male soldier.

**October 12** British nurse Edith Cavell is executed by the Germans in Belgium for helping Allied troops.

### 1916

French women privately create auxiliary military service organizations within the French War Office; 70,000 women enroll.

**December** The Prussian War Office creates the Women's Central Work Office, headed by the social worker Dr. Marie-Elisabeth Lüders, to help bring female workers into factories.

### 1917

**March** Women known as "Yeomanettes" enlist in the US Navy; 600 are on duty by May.

**March 31** The British Women's Army Auxiliary Corps arrives in France and Belgium to fill support roles due to a manpower shortage caused by the bloody Battle of the Somme in 1916.

**July** The First Russian Women's Battalion of Death is sent to the front line.

**October 25** The First Petrograd Women's Battalion is sent to defend the Provisional Government against Russian revolutionaries, but it is overwhelmed by Bolshevik forces.

◀ **BRITISH NURSES COLLECT FUNDS FOR MEDICAL SUPPLIES IN THE UK IN 1916.**

